# PLAYING WITH **FIRE**

**The massive fire that broke out on May 25 in Rajkot's TRP Game Zone and claimed 33 lives, including that of several children, highlights the severe safety lapses by the authorities and operators**

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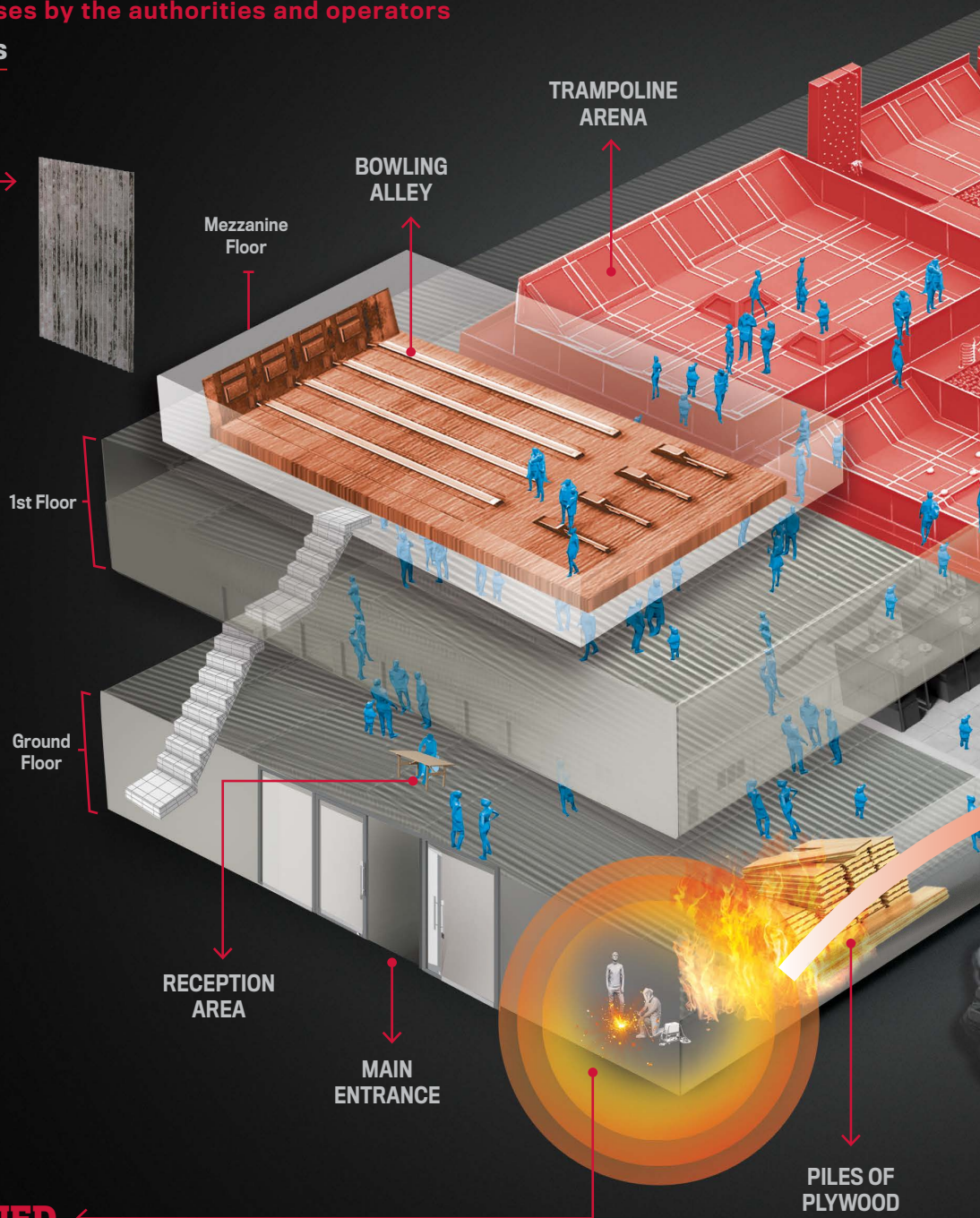
## THE STRUCTURE

The whole two-storey facility was made of tin. Almost all the walls were lined with highly inflammable plastic foam sheets



## THE LAPSES

- The game zone had only one door for entry and exit besides a flight of stairs. When the fire started, those on the first floor had no exit to escape through
- TRP mall workers had no clue about the fire rescue protocol. They closed connecting glass doors, trapping people on the first floor
- 2,000 litres of diesel, 1,500 litres of petrol and LPG cylinders were stored at the facility for generators, go-karting and F&B service requirements respectively
- Within a few minutes of the fire, a loud explosion brought down the tin shed, and reduced the place to cinders




## HOW IT **HAPPENED**

**5:34 PM** Fire starts (based on CCTV footage)

**5:47 PM** First fire tender reaches TRP Mall

**5:47 PM** First call made to the police



### HOW THE **FIRE SPREAD**

A spark from the welding work on the ceiling is believed to have touched plastic sheets lying below. Piles of plywood close-by resulted in rapid spread of the fire. Within 45 seconds, the blaze was uncontrollable

